

"IF TOMORROW THE PEOPLE OF KASHMIR START A FREEDOM MOVEMENT, THE PEOPLE OF PAKISTAN WILL BE WITH THEM."

ZULFIKAR ALI BHUTTO in Pakistan, after signing the Simla Agreement in India

NEHRU MEMORIAL LIBRARY



YEAR OF THE FEDERATION

As India celebrated 25 years of Independence, the Congress Party swept the state elections in March, riding on Indira Gandhi's *garibi hatao* programme and the victory over Pakistan. Arunachal Pradesh and Mizoram were declared Union territories and Meghalaya, Manipur and Tripura were awarded the status of full-fledged states.

THE MESSIAH

M.G. Ramachandran

Expelled from the DMK in 1972, MGR, the Tamil superstar-turned-political sensation, who was originally from Kerala, also demanded an enquiry into corruption in the parent party and went on to form the Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (later renamed AIADMK), named after the late Annadurai. A people's man, he later launched the successful mid-day meal scheme as chief minister of Tamil Nadu.

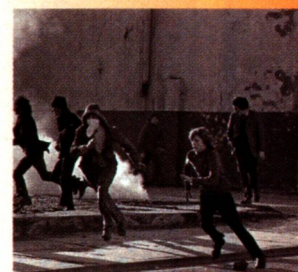


When India Got its Own War Vessel



INS Nilgiri, the first British-designed Indian-built modern warship of the Leander class, was commissioned into the naval fleet in Bombay. The 2,400-tonne, anti-submarine, all-purpose frigate equipped with a highly developed radar and sonar system, was one of the most modern and sophisticated warships of the type.

- The last of the US ground units withdrew from Vietnam. "Peace is at hand," announced Kissinger. The US Army also turned over its base at Long Binh to the South Vietnamese army, marking the end of US military involvement in the Vietnam War.



AFP

- The British Army killed 13 unarmed Roman Catholic civil rights marchers in Derry, Northern Ireland (above). The Bloody Sunday Massacre triggered anti-British riots in Ireland.
- An earthquake measuring 7.0 killed a fifth of the population of Iranian province of Fars.

10,00,000

women adopted family planning measures and the country's birth rate dropped to 3 per cent.

433 films were produced as India topped the world in film production. The Indian film industry is the biggest in the world now.